CS 301R · LAUNCH

Is It Ready to Tag?

Project _____

Repository _____

A release is a promise that everything in it is true. Teams at work run a release checklist before they ship; open-source projects check a release candidate before they tag it. The work isn't new writing; it's making each piece meet its bar. Mark each row twice: **today**, before you start (it tells you where to spend class), and **tagged**, just before you release.

What's in the repository at the tag *Each row: where it lives, and what it has to say. A short, true file beats a long, stale one.*

ITEM	WHERE IT LIVES	WHAT IT MUST CONTAIN	TODAY	TAGGED
README first screen need 1 · What is this?	`README.md`	What it does, for whom; a **status that matches what runs**; links to setup, onboarding, contributing, known issues	☐ done ☐ draft ☐ missing	☐
Welcome need 2 · Am I welcome?	`CONTRIBUTING.md` `CODE_OF_CONDUCT.md`	A warm first line; a **real, working** reporting contact; outside issues and PRs answered kindly	☐ done ☐ draft ☐ missing	☐
Setup guide need 3 · How do I start?	`docs/setup.md`	Prerequisites with versions → install → configure → **the test command** → run it. Nothing a stranger has to guess.	☐ done ☐ draft ☐ missing	☐
A test anyone can run need 3 · under the hood	`the test suite`	An automated test on the **core logic**, run by the setup guide's command, **passing**, asserting something real	☐ done ☐ draft ☐ missing	☐
Onboarding guide needs 1–5	`docs/onboarding.md`	The five needs answered, linking setup; a **tour of the code**: where the core logic lives, where a feature would go	☐ done ☐ draft ☐ missing	☐
Starter work need 4 · Where do I start?	*issues labeled* `good first issue`	Two or three, each doable **without asking**, with a where-to-start line (file or function)	☐ done ☐ draft ☐ missing	☐
Response need 5 · Will anyone respond?	`docs/communication-norms.md`	A response time **you'll keep after the term**; how you'll spot a waiting issue; where to ask	☐ done ☐ draft ☐ missing	☐
Known issues and tech debt under the hood	`docs/known-issues.md` *linked from the README*	Every throwaway corner, cut, unfixed audit finding, and onboarding-test stall, **each with its issue**	☐ done ☐ draft ☐ missing	☐
Architecture, as built under the hood	`docs/architecture.md`	Diagrams refreshed to what exists; **anything not built is deleted**	☐ done ☐ draft ☐ missing	☐
Roadmap need 4 · under the hood	`docs/roadmap.md`	Sequenced next steps; **a newcomer's first step**; claims only what the code supports	☐ done ☐ draft ☐ missing	☐
Retrospective the project's account of itself	`docs/retrospective.md`	Four headings (held or not · what v1 proved · what you'd change · what's next); every verdict backed by evidence; **agrees with the onboarding test**	☐ done ☐ draft ☐ missing	☐
Submitted, per person not in the repository	*the course site*	The **tag's URL** · your reflection (private, never committed) · a photo of the **signed Contributor-Readiness Checklist**		☐

Done: on *main* and meets the bar. **Draft:** on *main*, honest, not yet at the bar. **Missing:** not on *main*. Work on a branch doesn't count until it's merged.
Needs 1–5 are the newcomer questions from the Contributor-Readiness Checklist: what is this? · am I welcome? · how do I start? · where do I start? · will anyone respond?

Today's two work blocks: one item each

Block 1, before the test: fix what your tester is about to hit. The first of these that applies:

1. The test is missing, isn't run by the setup guide's command, or fails.
2. A file the tester reads is missing or false: setup, onboarding, README, starter issues.
3. One of your two worst audit stalls is still there.
4. Otherwise: the item furthest from its bar.

My block-1 item: _____

Block 2, after the test: one fix, the worst that fits. The earliest *fail* on your signed checklist, or else the earliest *stall*. Too big to fix? Log it properly instead: that's the block.

My block-2 item: _____

Before you tag, in this order

1. **Fix or log** every remaining stall and fail. Logging is a known-issues line and an issue (*good first issue* if a newcomer could fix it). No new features.
2. Bring every **draft** or **missing** row up to its bar.
3. Finish the **retrospective**, checked against the signed checklist, and merge it.
4. Run the **test command** from the setup guide on *main*. It passes.
5. **Tag and push:** `git tag -a v0.1-launch -m "launch"` then `git push origin v0.1-launch`
6. **Submit** the last row above.

Fix it or log it. Nothing ships undocumented, and nothing documented is untrue.